IFN582 Rapid Web Development with Databases
Assessment 1 – Initial Design of the Web Application
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1. Solution Description

1.1. Chosen focus area

MakeArtsFund is a crowdfunding web application designed to support creative arts projects in Australia. The platform connects local artists with supporters who wish to contribute to original artistic work. It is intended to assist artists in raising funds for projects in various categories such as Visual Arts, Handicrafts, 3D Printing, Photography, Music, and Film & Performance. Users can browse campaigns by category and location, helping them discover creative projects in their local communities.

1.2. Purpose of the application

Unlike general crowdfunding websites, MakeArtsFund emphasises local creativity and community engagement. The application is designed to assist early-stage artists in developing innovative ideas into viable creative projects. Each campaign displays its associated location and artistic category, allowing supporters to identify projects that are relevant to their interests or communities.

Besides, completed campaigns that achieved their funding goals are presented in a dedicated Success Stories section. This section demonstrates the creative ideas made possible through community support, providing potential supporters with evidence of the platform's positive impact.

1.3. Target audience

The target users of MakeArtsFund are artists located in Australia, supporters of creative projects and platform administrators. Artists use the platform to create campaigns by describing their creative ideas, establishing funding targets and publishing project updates. Supporters use the public interface to browse featured projects, explore specific categories, review detailed project information and contribute to selected campaigns. Administrators operate the platform by approving newly submitted campaigns, managing user accounts, handling reported issues and selecting projects for the featured and Success Stories sections on the Home Page.

1.4. Core features of the solution

1.4.1. Home Page

The Home Page is the most visually engaging page to attract potential donors to browse and donate. It includes essential components of content they need to understand quickly, such as a navigation bar with a search function, artistic categories, a concise explanation of how the platform operates, featured projects, a Success Stories section, and a footer.

The “How It Works” section explains the platform through three simple steps: Discover, Support, and Create. For the Featured Project section, at least three active projects should be shown. Each project card includes an image, project title, artist name, artistic category, location, funding progress bar and campaign countdown. Visitors should be directed to the Fundraiser Details and Donation Page when selecting the project card.

Another outstanding feature is the Success Stories Session, which should be displayed separately from active projects. Campaigns that achieved their goals are labelled as “Completed”, allowing users to clearly distinguish them from projects that are currently seeking support.

1.4.2. Fundraiser Details and Donation Page

The Fundraiser Details and Donation Page shall contain the most comprehensive content of one selected project for donors to review. The page includes the project title, artist name, artistic category, location, project image, fundraising goal, current amount raised, funding progress and campaign countdown.

Additional sections describe the project, introduce the artist, supplement project updates and display supporter messages. Project updates, such as milestones reached and upcoming exhibitions, can demonstrate the creators' ongoing progress. This feature enhances transparency, reinforces trust and encourages continued engagement with the campaign.

A clear call-to-action button, “Fund This Art”, from the Funding Summary section directs users to the donation form. The donation form should request the pledge amount, supporter name, supporter email address and payment method. The payment will be confirmed after the supporter clicks on the “Pay” button in the donation form.

Supporters who wish to leave a message can do so when they complete checkout. It will then be shown in the Supporter Messages section.

1.4.3. Campaign Management Page

The campaign management page provides artists with a data-driven and structured dashboard to monitor and maintain their projects. It identifies the selected project and displays key information. The Campaign Overview section illustrates figures and analysis of the specific project, including the funding progress, number of supporters and campaign countdown. Each transaction record is shown in the Recent Donations section for reference. Informative descriptions shown in the Fundraiser Details and Donation Page can be revised by the creators on this page. The project description, self-introduction and project updates are editable. The dashboard provides a clear distinction between the public campaigns interface and private campaign management interface.

1.4.4. Administrator Dashboard

The Administrator Dashboard acts as a moderator for the MakeArtsFund admin team to oversee the platform by reviewing platform statistics, approving submitted projects, managing artist and supporter accounts, monitoring reported content, selecting active projects on the Home Page's Featured Projects section, and showcasing completed campaigns in the Success Stories section.

The Administration Overview section provides cards to illustrate statistics such as the total number of campaigns, creators, supporters and reports for their investigation. The Pending Project Approvals section displays submitted campaigns requiring approval of projects. The Project Management section, showing project name and creator name, allows staff to suspend or delete active projects. The User Management section lists artist and supporter accounts, including their roles, account statuses and controls for editing, approving, suspending or deleting accounts. The Reported Content section identifies reported issues with the reason, reporter information, report submission date and the corresponding review status. Administrators can select active projects featuring on the Home Page in the Featured Projects section and manage completed campaigns displayed as Success Stories. It plays a crucial role in maintaining the quality, safety and visibility of published projects and created accounts in MakeArtsFund.

1.4.5. Overall Design and Layout

The visual design of this platform reflects creativity and professionalism by applying a consistent colour palette across all webpages. To stand out for brand recognition, a dark charcoal tone is used for primary text, contrasting with the warm light background. One strong primary colour, such as coral and one secondary colour, such as ash grey, are used for action buttons and highlighted labels. This colour match demonstrates an artistic visual identity while preserving disparity and readability.

Web layout should be consistent and clear across all four pages. The website uses a sans-serif typeface with clear headings to support readability across desktop, tablet and mobile screens. The same navigation bar, footer, button style and typography should be applied on each page. Bootstrap cards, grids and tables are used to structure the interface across diverse screen sizes.

2. User stories and acceptance criteria

2.1. User Story 1

As a visitor, I want to browse outstanding art projects on the Home Page so that I can immediately spot the one that interests me.

2.1.1. Acceptance Criteria 1

- At least three featured projects should be shown per row on large screens on the Home Page.
- Projects are displayed as cards.
- Each card contains an image, a project name, a creator's name, a category, a location, a progress bar and a funding countdown.
- Direct visitors to the Fundraiser Details and Donation Page by clicking the box.
- Add a "Discover More" button for visitors to discover more projects.

2.2. User Story 2

As a supporter, I want to view successfully funded campaigns so that I can understand the positive impact of community support and feel more confident in funding projects.

2.2.1. Acceptance Criteria 2

- Add a Success Stories section on the Home Page.
- Display completed projects in the Success Stories section separately from active projects in the Featured Projects section.
- Label projects in the Success Stories section as “Completed” to clearly distinguish achieved projects from featured projects.
- At least two successfully completed projects should be shown per row on large screens on the Home Page.
- Projects are displayed as a card.
- Each card contains an image, a project name, a creator’s name, a category, a location and a one-liner description of the project.

2.3. User Story 3

As a supporter, I want to browse projects by categories so that I can explore creative artworks which match my interests.

2.3.1. Acceptance Criteria 3

- Display categories on the Home Page, such as Visual Arts, Handicrafts, 3D Printing, Photography, Music, and Film & Performance.
- Label each category with even spacing.

2.4. User Story 4

As a backer, I want to find projects based on the location so that I can support artists in my city.

2.4.1. Acceptance Criteria 4

- Display the location in project cards from the Featured Projects section on the Home Page.
- Keep showing the location from the Project Overview section on the Fundraiser Details and Donation Page.
- Creators should identify the location when creating a new project from the Project Information section on the Campaign Management Page.

2.5. User Story 5

As a supporter, I want to review detailed project information so that I can make an informed decision before donating.

2.5.1. Acceptance Criteria 5

- Display project information including the project image, project title, name of the creator, category and location on the Fundraiser Details and Donation Page.
- Add a Funding Summary section, including the funding progress bar, funds raised, fundraising goal, number of supporters, and campaign countdown on the Fundraiser Details and Donation Page.
- Include an “About This Project” section as a project description on the Fundraiser Details and Donation Page.
- Include an “About the Artist” section to introduce the artist of the corresponding project on the Fundraiser Details and Donation Page.
- Include a Project Updates section to list any upcoming events or milestones made by the creators on the Fundraiser Details and Donation Page.

2.6. User Story 6

As a supporter, I want to submit a donation form so that I can contribute to a project idea I appreciate.

2.6.1. Acceptance Criteria 6

- Users need to fill in a donation form on the Fundraiser Details and Donation Page.
- The donation form requires the donor's pledge amount, name, email and payment method on the Fundraiser Details and Donation Page.
- Insert an eye-catching button "Fund this Art", directing supporters to the donation form on the Fundraiser Details and Donation Page.
- Insert a clear button "Pay" to confirm the payment on the Fundraiser Details and Donation Page.
- Allow supporters to leave a message to the creators when submitting the donation form on the Fundraiser Details and Donation Page.
- Show messages from the supporters in the Supporter Message section on the Fundraiser Details and Donation Page.

2.7. User Story 7

As an artist, I want to update my project information so that supporters can review the most updated campaign details.

2.7.1. Acceptance Criteria 7

- Add an “Edit Project Information” section for creators to edit the project title, category, location, fundraising goal, project description and self-introduction on the Campaign Management Page.
- Add a “Save Changes” button to the “Edit Project Information” section on the Campaign Management Page.
- Add a “Publish Update” button for creators to publish new project updates on the Campaign Management Page.
- Allow creators to review previous project updates on the Campaign Management Page.
- Allow creators to upload pictures in the Project Updates section on the Campaign Management Page.

2.8. User Story 8

As a creator, I want to monitor the performance of my projects so that I can access their progress towards the fundraising target.

2.8.1. Acceptance Criteria 8

- Allow the creator to select their project with a drop-down menu on the Campaign Management Page.
- Show the status of the creator's selected project on the Campaign Management Page.
- Display the total amount raised on the Campaign Management Page.
- Display the fundraising goal on the Campaign Management Page.
- Calculate and show the percentage of funding achieved in the progress bar on the Campaign Management Page.
- Show the number of supporters of the corresponding project on the Campaign Management Page.
- Show the campaign countdown on the Campaign Management Page.
- Add a Recent Donations section to list recent donation activity, including the supporter's name, donation date, pledge amount and transaction status on the Campaign Management Page.
- Add a Supporter Messages section to show all messages received by the creators from the supporters.

2.9. User Story 9

As a MakeArtsFund admin team member, I want to review recently submitted campaigns so that only approved campaigns are published on the platform.

2.9.1. Acceptance Criteria 9

- Display the number of active campaigns in the Administration Overview section on the Administrator Dashboard.
- Display the number of campaigns pending for the admin team to approve in the Administration Overview section on the Administrator Dashboard.
- Add a Pending Project Approvals section to display project information that is pending approval, including project name, creator name, project category, location and project submission date, on the Administrator Dashboard.
- Add an “Approve” and a “Reject” button in the Pending Project Approvals section on the Administrator Dashboard.
- Add a label showing the number of campaigns pending for the admin team to approve in the Pending Project Approvals section on the Administrator Dashboard.
- Add an “Export as Excel” button for the admin team to do easier and further investigation from the database in the Pending Project Approvals section on the Administrator Dashboard.

2.10. User Story 10

As an administrator, I want to review reported content so that potentially inappropriate content can be banned and removed from the platform.

2.10.1. Acceptance Criteria 10

- Display submitted reports in the Reported Content section on the Administrator Dashboard.
- Show the reported content, report reason, reporter name, reporter role, report submission date and status in the Reported Content section on the Administrator Dashboard.
- Add a “Review” and a “Resolve” button for the administrator to update the corresponding report status in the Reported Content section on the Administrator Dashboard.
- Add a label showing the number of reports pending for the admin team to review in the Reported Content section on the Administrator Dashboard.
- Add an “Export as Excel” button for the admin team to further investigate the database in the Pending Project Approvals section on the Administrator Dashboard.